

Regular Meeting
May 16, 2016
School Committee Meeting
Council Chambers

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke in the City Hall Council Chambers at 7:00 p.m. Those present were Ms.Cugno, Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Skerry, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke and Superintendent Belson.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry that the minutes of May 2, 2016 be approved:
Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry that the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved:
Voted: That the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry that the Payrolls be approved:
Voted: That the Payrolls be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot to suspend the rules to take papers out of order:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Superintendent Belson introduced the McGlynn Middle School Ensemble. He reported that the Medford Middle Schools String Ensemble was founded in 2009 by Medford teacher Sophia Chang to encourage the development of musical excellence. Since 2011, the ensemble has received six consecutive Gold medals at MICCA Concert Festival. The String Ensemble performed at Boston Symphony Hall and Mechanics Hall in Worcester. Tonight they will perform two selections: Cakewalk from “Serenade for String orchestra” by Norman Leyden and Lullaby by William Hofeldt. At the completion of the musical presentation the students were presented with certificates from the School Committee.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot said that there is no better reminder of what excellence we have in the Medford Public Schools. She is so proud of these students; you can see the determination

and joy in their faces. Ms. Cugno is so impressed and proud of these students. Ms. DiBenedetto said that the students fill the room with beauty, grace and art.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

A 5-minute recess was held at 7:24 p.m.

The meeting reconvened at 7:32 p.m.

Community Participation

Ann Frennin Kosauth from the Medford Educational Foundation gave an update. She explained that The Medford Educational Foundation (MEF) is a non-profit foundation committed to supporting innovation and excellence in the Medford Public Schools. Our goal is to enhance educational opportunities for all Medford students by investing in classroom enrichment and professional development to support innovative teaching. The MEF recently presented \$6,000 in grants to various programs throughout the Medford Public Schools. Applications for the next round are being accepted.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot thanked the members of the MEF for their dedication and vision. She realizes the time and hardwork of these dedicated members. She also thanked Ms. Velie for her guidance through the set up process.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Community member Angela Moore was given permission to speak. Ms. Moore once again asked the School Committee for a transition/succession plan for June 2016. She emphasized that selecting a Superintendent is the most important role of the School Committee. She was very upset that none of the members of the School Committee commented on her previous remarks.

Discussion:

There was considerable discussion about the process of selecting a new superintendent between members of the Committee and members of the audience. Members commented on Ms. Moore's presentation and the continued request for a succession plan.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno to hold a Committee of the Whole to discuss the transition and evaluation of the Superintendent.

Mayor Burke informed the Committee that a Committee of the Whole is being scheduled for June 2, 2016 for the Evaluation of the Superintendent.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto that the Superintendent provide his self evaluation to the members of the School Committee by Friday, May 20th:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto that the School Committee have a succession plan/process started by June 30, 2016:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to revert back to the regular order of business:

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

Buildings and Grounds Sub-Committee Minutes May 9, 2016

Chairperson Ann Marie Cugno read the minutes. The meeting of the Buildings and Grounds Sub-Committee was called to order at 7:05 p.m. by Chairperson Ann Marie Cugno. Sub-Committee members present were Kathy Kreatz and Paulette Van der Kloot. Also present were School Committee members Erin DiBenedetto and Robert Skerry Jr. Also Superintendent Roy E. Belson, Director of Finance and Administration Patricia Velie, Director of Buildings and Grounds John McLaughlin, Assistant Director of PE/Health and Community Schools Rachel Perry. Community members present included Katie Martin for Medford Soccer and Denis MacDougal of the Office of Energy and Environment.

All rose to salute the Flag.

Chairperson Cugno asked the Superintendent to explain the purpose of the meeting.

The Superintendent explained the purpose as follows:

1. Review the specification conditions for the proposed winter season “Bubble” on Edgerly Field.
2. Review the proposed Facilities Rental Agreement and Fee Schedule for the Medford Community Schools Programs.

The Superintendent informed the sub-committee of two additional comments that must be discussed as we go forward with our discussion.

1. OCD Director Lauren DiLorenzo explained that since federal CDBG/HUD funds were used to remove architectural barriers from the entrance/exit to the field, the use of the “Bubble” would have to make the same accessibility provisions as the pool. This means that the facility must make provision for low income and disabled users. Also any profits might have to go back and reimburse the HUD funding.

2. Ken Krause raised several environment concerns:

- Need to construct the proposed parking lot with appropriate stormwater management techniques.
- Possible impact on the Fells
- Size and location of the field house
- Possible impact upon new Winthrop Street development.

Denis MacDougal from the Energy and Environment Office suggested that installation of appropriate drainage as part of the parking lot was a must. He also would have preferred pavers as an alternative to hardtop for the parking lot. He recognized that the cost would be very high. The Superintendent explained that the Winthrop Street development has not even been submitted and that it would not affect the parking area. Also, the field house size had not yet been established but it would probably be about 1000 square feet. Also the parking lot would not be adjacent to the Middlesex Fells area. The Committee then began a review of the RFP guidelines for the “Bubble” structure. The Committee took the following actions:

1. Added the words “with appropriate drainage.”
2. Specified that the field house have at least two toilets in each of the male and female bathroom areas. Further that they be handicap accessible.
3. Required the vendor/contractor to hold a four-hour open house at least once during the season for the community. This will be listed as number 15.

There was considerable discussion on how the schedule of the “Bubble” could provide more time for community use. Suggestions included such ideas as:

- Having the contractor start later on Wednesdays
- Adding a later finishing time in exchange for more time in the afternoons and weekends
- Sharing space during contractor time

These ideas were rejected for several reasons. There was concern that the hours available would not be conducive for parents to bring children and youth to the facility during afternoon hours.

There was discussion that the facility could provide opportunities for adult residents like the pool does. For example there could be tennis, golf, track related activities. While the adult use was understood, the committee was trying to find more time for children and youth. Ultimately the committee opted to include a four hour open house requirement once per season.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz the sub-committee voted 3-0 to forward and recommend the amended RFP guidelines to the full school committee. (see attached)

The sub-committee then began its review of the Proposed “Facilities Rental Agreement”. Director of Finance and Administration took the sub-committee through each page.

Discussion was held at intervals as each member raised questions and/or made suggestions. The following represents the changes made by the sub-committee:

1. The liability insurance requirement was changed to “may be” from “it is required”.
2. The age of “21” was substituted for the word “minors”
3. On page 4 the time for activity termination was changed from 11:30 p.m. to 11:00 p.m.

4. Hormel Stadium line was altered as follows: Hormel Stadium rentals are controlled by the Hormel Commission. Contact information (781) 393-2380
5. Under pool fees the non-resident fee for birthday parties was raised to \$275 from \$125 per hour. Also birthday party rental included up to two lifeguards. If swimmer numbers exceed 20 then additional lifeguards and applicable costs will apply.
6. On page 7 the rental fees for Edgerly field were changed. Categories 1,2,3 remained at \$145 per hour. Category 4 (for profit) went to \$185. Non-resident non-profit went to \$165.
7. Under Food Service fees the words added “with the exception of birthday parties”.

The chairperson called for a 10 minute recess. Members were asked to review the last three pages of the proposal which contained the “Facility Usage Request Form” and the “Release/Indemnification Agreement.”

The sub-committee reconvened and agreed that the forms looked good. They will be reviewed by legal counsel.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. Kreatz the sub-committee voted to recommend the Facilities Rental Agreement Proposal as amended to the full school committee 3-0.

The sub-committee then reviewed the financial reports on Community Schools, the pool, Edgerly Field, and LaConte Rink. (see attached overview – financial documents on file) In addition to the report materials presented the sub-committee asked to receive the following information:

- Names of entities that have been given free space
- Names of employees who have worked the pool, field and rink
- Clear breakout of pending revenue

The sub-committee on the motion of Ms. Kreatz seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot voted to adjourn at 10:05 p.m.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot that the list of changes on page 3 includes the information regarding the required four hour open house but it should be included as #8 and asked for this correction to be made.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to accept the RFP guidelines as amended by Ms. Van der Kloot:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to accept the Facility Rental Agreement and send to legal for review and to hold the fee schedule in abeyance to be reviewed/discussed at a sub committee meeting to be scheduled.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0

Absent: 0

Ms. Cugno would like the security deposit item to say “non-refundable” security deposit if not cancelled within 48 hours.

On motion of Ms. Van der Kloot to approve as amended without the fee schedule which will be discussed at a future meeting and would like to invite the members of the Hormel Commission to attend.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

A two-minute recess was held at 9:27 p.m.

Meeting reconvened at 9:31 p.m.

Update Report on Medford Vocational Technical High School

Director of Medford Vocational School Dr. Heidi Riccio presented the update. Dr. Riccio requested the approval of the School Committee for students to attend the SkillsUSA National Competition in Louisville, Kentucky from June 22 –25, 2016. MVTHS has two students that qualify for nationals. She also stated that a funding source has not yet been determined.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot asked what the cost is projected to be? Dr. Riccio said approximately \$1500 each, so \$4800 total for 1 teacher and two students. They will try to do some fundraising to offset this cost. Ms. Van der Kloot asked that the students be invited to a future meeting.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno to approve the student’s attending the SkillsUSA National Competition in Louisville, Kentucky.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

Dr. Riccio continued with the Teen Dating Violence Prevention Grant. She reported that this is a 3 year program to promote healthy relationships and addresses teen dating violence. It is a collaborative grant with MHS and MVTHS. She also informed the committee of a collaboration with Bunker Hill Community College regarding a new course Emergency Medical Responder for SY 16-17. This is a 4 credit course offered by BHCC and open to both MHS and MTHS students during the day. She gave an overview of pending grants. Dr. Riccio also reported that a senior in the electrical program was asked to participate in a lead story for the New York Times relating to vocational education across the nation.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto mentioned that regarding teen dating the PTO used to bring in the Yellow Dress, is this program used any longer? She suggested contacting Ann Reppucci for more information on this program.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

Pre Budget Report – Guidance

Director of Guidance Amelia Jensen presented the report. Ms. Jensen said the mission of the guidance department is to ensure all students thrive in the areas of academic development, college and career preparation, and social/emotional wellness by being immersed in an environment that enhances learning, values diversity, inspires self-discovery, and provides innovative opportunities through dynamic school, student, family and community partnerships. Ms. Jensen highlighted the major accomplishments of the department for the year and gave budget requests for next year.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno said she is proud of the accomplishments of our students with their college acceptances. She asked that all acceptances be included in the booklet. Ms. Van der Kloot asked if the district funds AP tests. Ms. Jensen replied no, however if the student is on a free or reduced lunch then the rate is reduced. Ms. Van der Kloot would like to try to find funding for these exams. Ms. Kreatz asked Ms. Jensen if she thinks that one guidance counselor is enough for the vocational school. Ms. Jensen said that they have been talking about integrating a high school and vocational counselor. Ms. DiBenedetto commented that this is quite an extensive list of colleges, it shows what is being done is producing great students. She also said that the school committee voted to have additional people on the stage, she was making sure that Mrs. Repucci has been invited.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

Pre Budget Report – Fine Arts

Director of the Fine Arts Department Richard Trotta presented the report. Mr. Trotta reported that music programs are available to students in grades K-12 and include offerings in vocal, classroom, music appreciation and instrumental music. The visual art program presents opportunities for students to explore and develop talents in a variety of art forms. Mr. Trotta presented an overview of the accomplishments of both the music and art programs. He also presented his budget request for next year.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot commented that all the concerts were wonderful. Ms. Cugno asked how many students can't fit band in their schedule. Mr. Szykniej, head music teacher, answered that the high school has about 117 requests and 70% can schedule it. There is the need for another band teacher. Ms. DiBenedetto asked where we stand with the antique instruments? She would like an update on the evaluation on these instruments.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto that the Superintendent provide a list of inventory including the value of the instruments by the end of September.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Report on National Science Foundation Computer Application Grant Program

Superintendent Belson introduced Molly Laden to present the report. Ms. Laden stated that the Middle School Pathways in Computers Science project is a partnership of the University of Massachusetts Lowell, the Tri-City Education Collaborative (TRITEC) and the Medford and Everett Public School districts to bring project-based, socially relevant computing experiences to district middle school students. The project goals are to increase student awareness of computer science careers, motivate students to pursue high school educational pathways to these careers and to bring creative computing experiences and career awareness activities to traditionally under-represented populations in computing. She also explained the implementation of the grant.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot said that this is fantastic. She asked what happens when the grant ends, she would like to see this continue. Ms. DiBenedetto asked if the students have a chance to learn coding? Ms. Laden answered that all k-5 students do an introduction to coding.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Report on Summer Programs

Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson presented the report. Ms. Nelson reported that administrators have been meeting to plan this year's summer programs. Some of the programs are budget or grant funded; others are supported by student tuition. Some programs are designed for specific populations; others are open to all students. The

programs for this year include the following: Summer Fun Program for elementary students, Regular Summer School for middle and high school students, English Language Learner Summer Program for elementary, middle and high school students, Middle School Computer Science Camp for middle school students, Medford Vocational Technical High School CTE Explore for middle school students, High School 101 for students entering grade 9 and Special Education Programs for PK – high school students.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno asked if students taking an online program must do this at school. Ms. Nelson answered yes.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Report on Community Schools

Superintendent Belson stated that the School Committee received reports which provide information on the various program facilities under the Community Schools umbrella. The report contains information about the following: Community Schools, LoConte Rink, MHS/Community Pool and Edgerly Field. The report details the names of renters, revenues, expenditures and personnel. These programs provide valuable opportunities to the children, youth and adults of Medford. Director of Finance Pat Velie continued by stating that the reports she distributed tonight should have met all requests. She also said that the pool is getting busier and that the community schools should end the year in the positive.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto asked if they have an estimate on the amount of revenue that will be coming in? Ms. Velie answered that known revenue is \$271,000. Ms. DiBenedetto would like anyone using the community schools facilities to fill out a form so that we can track the usage.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto that anyone using the community schools facilities to fill out a form whether paying or not to track usage beginning July 1st:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Ms. DiBenedetto continued by saying that with all the different programs and rentals of facilities isn't there a conflict of interest with our employees or entities renting. She asked if we have staff that work and/or rent? Director of community Schools Robert Maloney answered that the Middlesex Reds have no paid personnel from the Medford Public Schools. He also said that a list of paid employees was distributed tonight. Superintendent Belson commented that American International College contracts through our office. No faculty teaches for AIC but from time to time that some of our administrators with expertise in licensure will supervise students. Ms. DiBenedetto asked the Superintendent to check with legal on this matter.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Negotiations and Legal Matters placed at the end of the calendar.

New Business:

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Mildred McCormack. Mildred was the wife of former Medford High School Headmaster William A. McCormack and former MHS teacher/administrator Jeffrey McCormack.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Jill Marie Analetto-DeSimone. Jill was the daughter of long time Medford resident and faithful supporter Thomas Analetto.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Barbara Howe. Barbara was a long time Medford resident and former custodian at Medford High School.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to go into Executive Session at 11:26 p.m. for the discussion of open meeting law complaint v. City of Medford School Committee MGL C30(a) section 23 and collective bargaining contracts update.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

The Committee returned from Executive Session at 11:46 p.m.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry, seconded by Ms. Cugno the meeting was adjourned at 11:47 p.m.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

Respectfully submitted:

Robert E. Skerry Jr.

Secretary